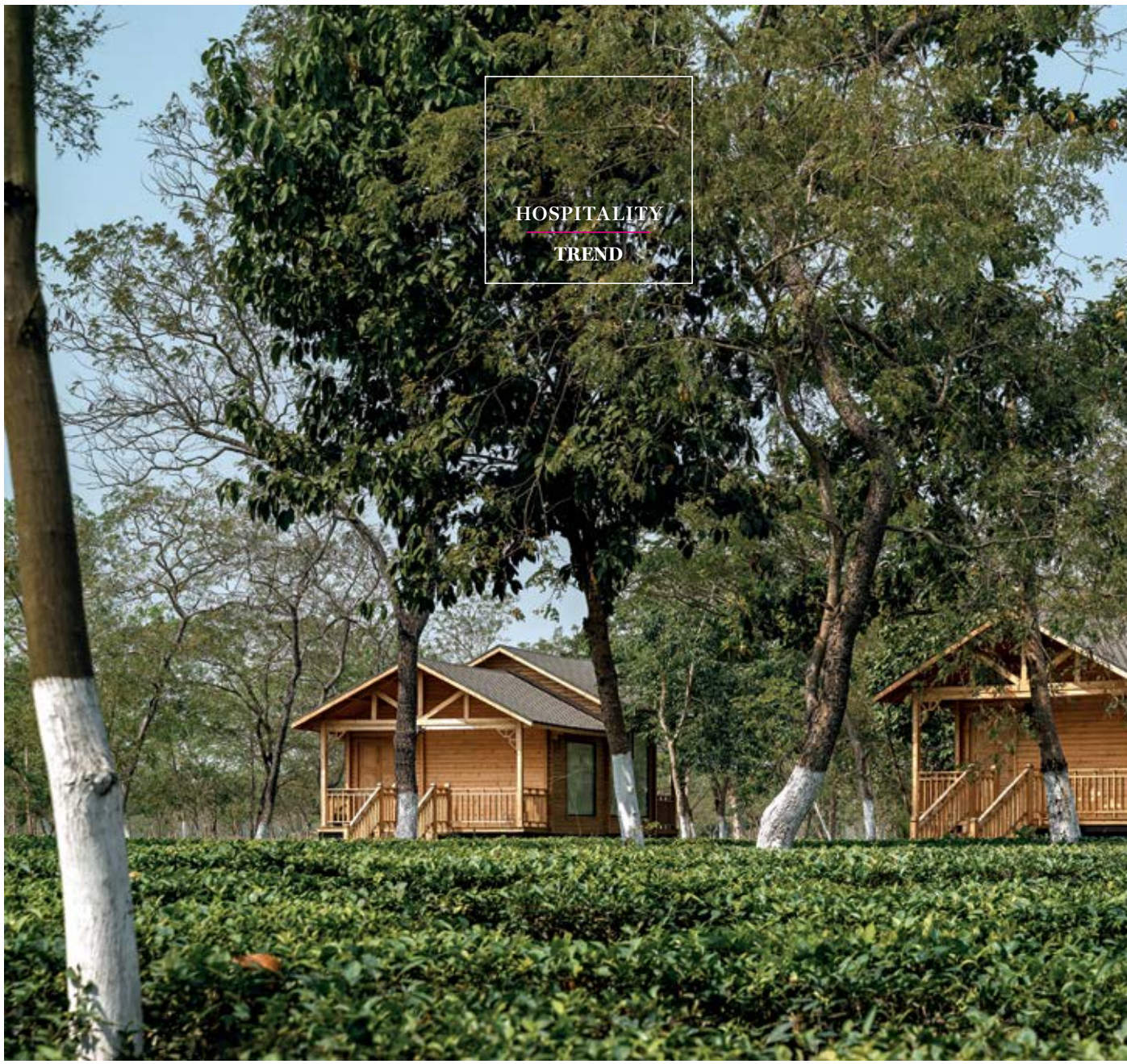


coastline such as Maravanthe is to begin with the destination rather than the demand. These are not hotels positioned simply to capture an established circuit of weddings, corporate travel or familiar tourist traffic. The proposition is more ambitious: that the place itself is worth the journey. In such locations, a hotel cannot merely transplant the familiar vocabulary of luxury. It has to interpret what is already there: its landscape, food, architecture, histories, rhythms and people, and offer enough comfort to let a traveller enter that world without insulating them from it.

Yet choosing an extraordinary destination is only half the equation. If travel is genuinely to become experiential, the hotel itself has to stop interrupting the experience. This is where "experience-led" hospitality has to become more than a programming calendar. A waterfall trail, a dive, a tea-plucking morning or an archery lesson can all be sold as experiences. But if the guest is still structuring the day around a standardised breakfast buffet that closes at 10.30 or a rigid noon checkout, the operating model undermines the very immersion it claims to provide.

The best experiential hospitality therefore does something counterintuitive: it makes itself less intrusive. Breakfast happens when the guest is hungry, allowing a slower morning to take hold rather than ending when the buffet closes. Regional dishes are prepared à la carte rather than reduced to another interchangeable spread. Arrival and departure bend around the journey wherever possible, rather than forcing the journey to bend around the hotel.